are too many responsibilities for any one person to handle. The entire organogram of the MoD therefore needs to be reworked to achieve true integration within the MoD. Ideally, through cross-staffing, every alternate echelon should be from the uniformed service, at the Director and above level. The three Vice-Chiefs too should have powers akin to the Additional Secretary in the DMA. This will minimize the need to refer each and every case to the Ministry. While to the outside world the MoD is one entity, in actuality, it is more like the Ministry as one entity and the three Service HQs as separate entities. Delays are not in the Service HQ but in the Ministry, a faceless, unfeeling creature. These should be interim measures, however, with ultimately each of the Services becoming full-fledged Departments within the MoD, with the Vice-Chiefs exercising the powers of Secretary, akin to the Department of Defence Production, Department of Ex-Servicemen Welfare, etc., each of which has its own Secretary-level officer heading the department.

However, more important than this organizational change is the attitudinal change that is required, which will allow the organizational changes to fructify. As long as the Armed Forces are kept out of the decision-making loop, there can be no real reform. The CDS/permanent Chairman of the Chiefs of Staff Committee is not even a permanent member of the CCS. In the aftermath of the accidental firing of a BrahMos missile by the Air Force, I, as the officiating Chairman of the Chiefs of Staff Committee and COAS, was neither called nor consulted even once. Yet, had there been any adverse fallout of the incident, it would have been the three Services at the forefront of the action. This suspicion on the loyalty of the Armed Forces and the canard that the Army will stage a 'coup' if given more powers must be laid to rest once and for all. Unless all facets

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